PROFILEOS — UI/UX Design Document

Your career. Your identity. Your future.

Prepared for: Nimesh · Scope: public website, authenticated workspace, design system, key flows

1. Overview

PROFILEOS is an AI-powered professional identity platform. Users bring in what they already have (profile links, documents, manual entries), build one verified source of truth, and turn it into career assets: a published portfolio, CVs, and cover letters.

This document defines the UI/UX approach for the redesign. Its central decision is a **strict separation of two experiences**:

	Public website	Authenticated workspace
Purpose	Persuade and explain	Complete tasks
Mood	Cinematic, expressive	Calm, focused, productive
Density	Spacious, one idea per section	Clean, one job per page
Visual effects	Glows, gradients, motion	Minimal, functional

The workspace is never a crowded dashboard. Each major feature gets its own dedicated page and workspace.

2. Design Principles

1. **One screen, one job.** Every page answers a single question: where am I, and what do I do next?
2. **Navigation hub, not feature dump.** The Overview shows four actions and a progress indicator, nothing more.
3. **Truth over polish.** AI never invents qualifications, dates, employers or metrics. Missing data is requested or omitted.
4. **Everything is editable.** Generated content is always real, structured, editable content, never a flattened image.
5. **Show, then confirm.** Imported data is presented for review before it joins the profile.
6. **Real or absent.** No dead buttons, fake analytics or placeholder pages. If an integration lacks credentials, show a clear setup or unavailable state.

7. **Restraint.** Motion and glow serve hierarchy. Where in doubt, remove it.

3. Audience

PROFILEOS serves students, graduates, developers, designers, business professionals, freelancers, entrepreneurs, researchers and academics.

Segment	Primary need	UX implication
Student / graduate	First CV, little experience	Emphasise education, projects, skills; guide missing info
Developer	Show work fast	GitHub import, project-first portfolio
Designer / creative	Visual presence	Creative template, strong imagery control
Professional / freelancer	Targeted applications	Job-description tailoring, ATS CV
Researcher / academic	Credibility	Publications, academic CV template

The onboarding category selection adapts defaults (suggested sections, template order) to each segment.

4. Information Architecture

```
Public
├── Home (Hero → Integrations → How it works → Identity Engine → Studios → Templates → Trust → FAQ → CTA → Footer)
├── Sign In · Create Account · Forgot Password · Email Verification

Onboarding (optional, skippable)

Workspace
├── Overview
├── My Profile
├── Portfolio Studio
├── CV Studio
├── Cover Letter Studio
├── My Documents
└── Settings
```

The sidebar contains exactly the seven workspace items. Notifications and the profile menu live in the top bar. Nothing else is promoted to primary navigation.

5. Core Story and Mental Model

The product narrative, used on the homepage and mirrored in the app:

CONNECT → BUILD YOUR IDENTITY → CREATE → PUBLISH

Stage	Homepage message	Where it happens in the app
Connect	Bring your professional world together	Onboarding, My Profile
Build identity	One verified source of truth	My Profile
Create	Portfolio, CV, cover letter	The three Studios
Publish	Share and download	Portfolio publish, exports, My Documents

6. Design System

6.1 Colour

Proposed tokens. Dark is the brand default; the workspace also supports a light theme.

Token	Value	Use
`--bg-obsidian`	#07080C	Public site background
`--bg-charcoal`	#11131A	Surfaces, cards
`--bg-raised`	#181B25	Elevated panels, menus
`--border`	#262A36	Dividers, outlines
`--text-primary`	#F2F4F8	Headings, body
`--text-muted`	#8A91A3	Secondary text
`--accent-blue`	#3B82F6	Primary actions, links, focus
`--accent-violet`	#7C5CFF	Gradient partner, highlights
`--success`	#22C55E	Saved, verified

Token	Value	Use
`--warning`	#F59E0B	Needs attention
`--danger`	#EF4444	Destructive actions, errors

Rules: blue is the single primary action colour. Violet appears only in subtle gradients and highlights. Gradients are never used on body text or large surfaces in the workspace.

6.2 Typography

- **Display:** Space Grotesk, for hero and section headings.
- **Body and UI:** Inter or Geist.
- **Scale:** 12 / 14 / 16 / 18 / 24 / 32 / 48 / 64 px, with a clear step between heading levels.
- **Line height:** 1.6 body, 1.1–1.2 display.
- **Weights:** 400, 500, 600 for UI; 500–700 for display.

6.3 Spacing, shape, elevation

- 4 px base grid; common steps 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 80, 120.
- Radius: 8 px controls, 12 px cards, 20 px large surfaces.
- Elevation is expressed with borders and slight tonal shifts first, shadows second. Glow is reserved for hero visuals and primary CTAs on the public site.

6.4 Core components

Buttons (primary, secondary, ghost, destructive), inputs with inline validation, selects, tag inputs for skills, section cards with View/Add/Edit/Delete, modals and drawers, tabs, toasts, skeleton loaders, empty states, stepper, split-pane layout, template picker card, document card, version-history list, confirmation dialog.

Every component defines default, hover, focus, active, disabled, loading and error states.

7. Public Website

7.1 Navigation

Logo · Features · How it works · Templates · About · Sign In · **Create Your Identity** (primary button). Sticky and transparent at the top, solid on scroll. On mobile it collapses to a full-screen menu with the primary CTA pinned.

7.2 Hero

- **Headline:** "Everything you've built. One powerful professional identity."
- **Supporting text:** "Connect your professional world. Create your portfolio, CV, and personal brand — all from one place."
- **CTAs:** Create Your Identity (primary), Explore Features (secondary).
- **Visual:** A composed, layered product presentation: a portfolio preview, a CV preview and a professional identity card, over abstract gradient and subtle particle graphics. It must look like a designed product presentation, not a dashboard screenshot, and it must match what the real app produces.

7.3 Section sequence

#	Section	Intent
1	Hero	State the promise and show the product
2	Supported integrations	Build credibility with recognisable platforms
3	How PROFILEOS works	Four-step Connect → Identity → Create → Publish story
4	Professional Identity Engine	Explain the single source of truth
5	Portfolio Studio	Show a real portfolio and its editing
6	CV and Resume Studio	Show split-screen editing with live preview
7	Cover Letter Studio	Show tone selection and editable output
8	Personal Branding	Show the consistent identity across assets
9	Template gallery	Let visitors browse real templates
10	Privacy and trust	Explain data control and no unauthorised scraping
11	FAQ	Remove last objections
12	Final CTA	One clear action
13	Footer	Links, legal, contact

Each section uses generous vertical spacing (about 120 px desktop) and one visual focal point. Avoid oversized feature-card grids; alternate text-left/visual-right layouts to create rhythm.

7.4 Motion

Subtle fade-and-rise on scroll, slow parallax on hero graphics, hover lift on template cards. Durations 200–500 ms with ease-out. All motion respects `prefers-reduced-motion`.

8. Authentication

Four pages in the public visual language: Sign In, Create Account, Forgot Password, Email Verification.

- Centred card on an obsidian background with a restrained glow.
- Inline validation, visible password rules, show/hide password.
- Clear error messages that say what to do next.
- After success, route to onboarding (new users) or Overview (returning users). Never to a crowded dashboard.

9. Onboarding

Seven steps, all skippable where appropriate, with a persistent progress indicator and a "Skip for now" action.

Step	Content
1	Welcome to PROFILEOS
2	Choose professional category (Student, Developer, Designer, Business Professional, Freelancer, Entrepreneur, Researcher, Academic, Other)
3	Connect or add accounts (paste URLs; authorised connection where supported)
4	Upload documents
5	Review imported information
6	Complete the professional identity
7	Enter the workspace

Design notes: one decision per screen; imported data is shown as a reviewable list with accept, edit and discard per item; the user can leave and resume later from the profile completion indicator.

10. Workspace Shell

- **Sidebar (slim, collapsible on desktop):** Overview, My Profile, Portfolio Studio, CV Studio, Cover Letter Studio, My Documents, Settings. Icon plus label; icon-only when collapsed.
- **Top bar:** current page title, notifications (only if needed), profile menu.
- **Mobile:** bottom tab bar for the main destinations, with Settings in the profile menu; studios use full-screen flows.
- **Layout:** content max-width about 1200 px, generous padding, consistent page header with title and one primary action.

The workspace uses a calm palette: charcoal surfaces, no particle or glow effects, accent colour only for primary actions and focus.

11. Page Designs

11.1 Overview

- Heading: "Welcome back. Let's build your professional identity."
- Supporting text: "Your professional information, portfolio, and career documents — all in one place."
- **Four understated cards:** Create Portfolio, Create CV, Create Cover Letter, Manage Profile. Each is fully clickable.
- A small profile completion indicator, with a link to the next missing section.
- Recent documents appear only when real data exists.
- No fake charts or analytics.

11.2 My Profile

The single source of truth for all generation.

Sections: Basic Information, Social Profiles, Education, Qualifications, Work Experience, Internships, Projects, Skills, Certifications, Achievements, Awards, Publications, Volunteering, Languages, Interests, Professional Links.

Pattern: a left section list (or tabs on mobile) and a right editor. Each section supports View, Add, Edit, Delete, Save and Cancel, with entries shown as compact cards that expand into an edit form. Users can add custom sections.

Connect Your Professional World: a prominent panel for pasting URLs (LinkedIn, GitHub, personal site, Instagram, Facebook, Behance, other) with platform icons and URL validation. GitHub connects through its official API; LinkedIn only through officially

permitted capabilities. Unsupported platforms save the link only and say so plainly, with no promise of data extraction and no scraping.

+ Add Information: a persistent button that opens a guided drawer to add a qualification, degree, certification, project, experience, skill, achievement or award.

Imported data lands in a review state; nothing is merged until the user confirms it.

11.3 Portfolio Studio

Flow: Create Portfolio → choose type → choose template → select profile information → customise visuals → generate → preview → edit → save or publish.

Types: One-Page (primary), Professional, Creative.

Templates (genuinely different layouts, not recolours):

Template	Character
01 Minimal	Light, spacious, clean typography, restrained structure
02 Modern	Dark, premium type, blue or violet accents
03 Creative	Expressive typography, distinctive section compositions

Editor: a focused workspace with a section list (reorder, hide, add) on the left, a live preview in the centre with desktop/mobile toggle, and a style panel (colours, fonts, profile photo). Actions: Save draft, Publish, Unpublish.

Rendering: portfolios are rendered from a structured specification and reusable components. No static screenshots and no execution of AI-generated JavaScript.

11.4 CV Studio

Flow: select CV type → choose template → select profile information → enter target role → optionally paste job description → generate → edit → preview → export PDF or DOCX → save to My Documents.

Templates: ATS-Friendly, Minimal Professional, Modern, Academic, Executive, each with a distinct layout.

Editor: a split screen.

Left: controls	Right: live preview
Editable content per section	Paged CV, updates as you type
Reorder and show/hide sections	Page-break preview
Typography, font size, margins, colours	Template switching without losing content
Add section	Zoom and fit controls
Version history	Export PDF / DOCX

On mobile the split view becomes two tabs, Edit and Preview, with a sticky export button.

The CV is always structured, editable content, never an image.

11.5 Cover Letter Studio

Inputs: profile, company name, job title, job description, tone (for example formal, warm, confident, concise).

Output: a full letter in a clean document editor with preview, export and saved versions.

Guardrails: uses only verified profile data; does not invent company facts or achievements. Where company information is missing, the letter stays general or asks the user.

11.6 My Documents

Library of CVs, cover letters, portfolios, certificates, imported documents and generated assets.

- Search, filter by type, sort by date.
- Card or list view with preview.
- Actions: preview, download, rename, version history, delete (with confirmation).
- Meaningful empty states that point to the relevant Studio.

11.7 Settings

Account, Profile Preferences, Connected Accounts (disconnect and delete imported data), Privacy, Data Export, Account Deletion, Theme, Language, Notifications. Destructive actions sit in a clearly separated danger zone with explicit confirmation.

12. Key User Flows

New user to first CV

1. Landing → Create Your Identity → create account → verify email.
2. Onboarding: category → add GitHub link and upload an old CV.
3. Review imported data → accept and edit → continue.
4. Overview → Create CV → pick template → enter target role → generate.
5. Edit in split view → export PDF → saved to My Documents.

Profile to published portfolio

1. My Profile → complete Projects and Skills.
2. Portfolio Studio → One-Page → Modern template.
3. Select content → customise → generate → edit and preview on mobile.
4. Publish → copy public link; Unpublish remains available.

Tailored application

1. CV Studio → paste job description → generate tailored CV.
2. Cover Letter Studio → same role and company → choose tone → generate and edit.
3. Export both and find them under My Documents.

13. AI Interaction Design

- Generation buttons call the real backend; no hardcoded outputs.
- A visible "Generating…" state with the option to cancel.
- Generated content is marked as a draft until the user edits or accepts it.
- Where information is missing, the interface asks a specific question ("What was your end date at this role?") instead of guessing.
- Every generated asset is saved and versioned, with restore.
- AI suggestions for summaries are shown as proposals the user can accept, edit or reject.

14. Responsive Behaviour

Breakpoint	Behaviour
Desktop (≥1280)	Full sidebar, split-screen editors
Laptop (1024–1279)	Collapsible sidebar, narrower panels
Tablet (768–1023)	Collapsed sidebar, stacked panels where needed

Breakpoint	Behaviour
Mobile (<768)	Bottom navigation, single-column pages, tabbed editor/preview

The mobile design is purpose-built, not a shrunken desktop. The public website must remain visually strong on mobile, with the hero visual recomposed for a vertical layout.

15. Accessibility

- WCAG 2.2 AA contrast for all text and controls.
- Full keyboard navigation with visible focus rings in the accent blue.
- Semantic landmarks, labelled form fields, and error messages tied to inputs.
- Reduced-motion support; no information conveyed by colour alone.
- Touch targets at least 44 × 44 px.
- Exported PDFs from the ATS template must have selectable text and a logical reading order.

16. States and Edge Cases

State	Treatment
Empty	Short explanation plus one clear action
Loading	Skeletons matching the final layout
Error	Plain-language message, retry, no raw errors
Unsaved changes	Warning before navigating away; autosave indicator
Integration not configured	Clear setup or unavailable state
Offline or failed save	Preserve local edits and retry
Destructive actions	Confirmation dialog naming what will be deleted

17. Implementation Phasing

Phase	Deliverable
1	Public homepage redesign
2	Authentication and onboarding
3	Workspace shell and Overview
4	My Profile and manual information
5	Portfolio Studio and templates
6	CV Studio and editable generation
7	Cover Letter Studio
8	My Documents and Settings
9	AI integration, validation, testing, polish

Before building, inspect the existing codebase and preserve working functionality, architecture and integrations. Keep the public site, workspace, backend, AI workflows and portfolio renderer separate.

18. Acceptance Checklist

- Premium, story-driven public homepage that is also strong on mobile.
- Clean authentication and a skippable onboarding flow.
- Slim workspace with exactly seven destinations, each its own page.
- Overview with four actions and a completion indicator, with no fake data.
- Profile editor with all sections, URL validation and reviewable imports.
- Three genuinely distinct portfolio templates rendering real pages.
- Five distinct CV templates with split-screen live editing and real PDF/DOCX export.
- Editable, versioned cover letters from verified data.
- Searchable document library and complete settings.
- No dead buttons, no fabricated AI content, no unauthorised scraping.